



(<https://www.prophecynewswatch.com>)



Join over **350,000** PNW subscribers.

Enter Your Email

Subscribe to PNW

Discover more

[Failed state analysis](#)

[UK political news](#)

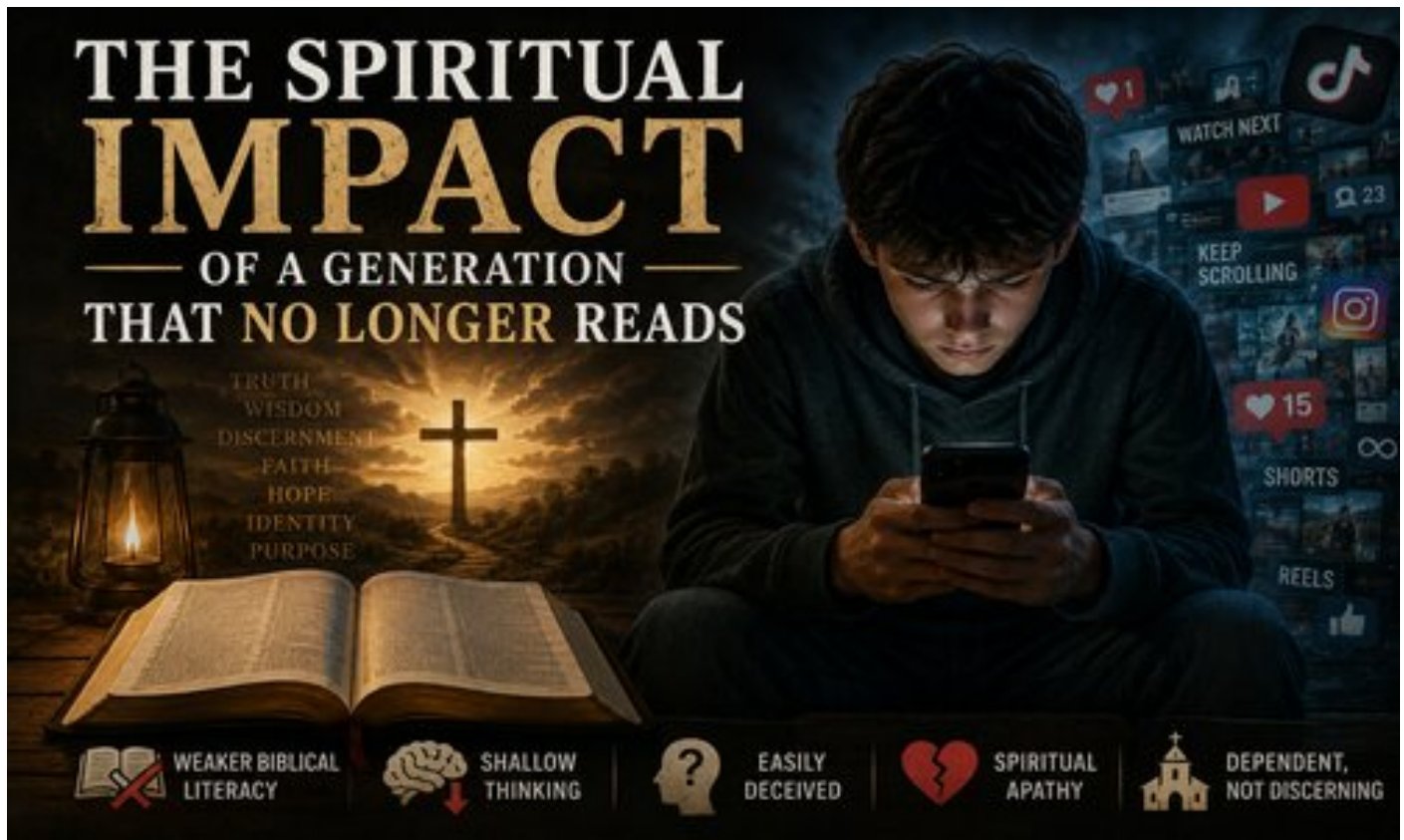
[Minister resignation reports](#)



(https://www.prophecynewswatch.com/product.cfm?product_id=76)

ARTICLE

The Spiritual Impact Of A Generation That No Longer Reads



BY PNW STAFF JUNE 13, 2026

Share this article:

[Share](#)[Post](#)[Email](#)[Share](#)[Print](#)

A quiet crisis is unfolding across America, and unlike many of the cultural battles that dominate headlines, this one receives surprisingly little attention.

The next generation is losing the ability to read deeply, think critically, and comprehend complex ideas.

Discover more[Labour Party history](#)[US political news](#)[Leadership resignation guide](#)

That may sound dramatic, but educators across the country are sounding the alarm. What they are witnessing in classrooms is not merely a decline in test scores. It is a fundamental shift in how young people process information and engage with the written word.

College literature instructor Tyler Jagt recently described how his students struggled to complete a simple 20-page article. Not a novel. Not a lengthy textbook chapter. A 20-page article.

Some students admitted they repeatedly lost track of the author's main points before reaching the end. Others relied on AI-generated summaries rather than reading the material themselves. What once would have been considered a routine assignment has become an overwhelming challenge for many incoming college students.

The data confirms what educators are seeing.

Discover more

Keir Starmer biography



Demographics



Office resignation resources



According to the 2024 National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP), reading scores among American 12th graders have fallen to their lowest levels since tracking began in 1992. Nearly one-third of graduating seniors scored below the basic reading level.

The numbers become even more alarming among younger students. The Annie E. Casey Foundation reports that roughly 70 percent of fourth graders are not reading proficiently. That represents nearly two million children who are struggling with a skill that forms the foundation of every other area of learning.

Some major urban school districts report even more concerning outcomes. In cities such as Baltimore, Detroit, and Cleveland, large percentages of students fail to meet grade-level reading standards. In certain schools, fewer than 10 percent of students demonstrate reading proficiency. While the exact numbers vary by district and year, the broader trend is undeniable.

America has a reading crisis.

The causes are not difficult to identify.

For generations, children grew up reading books, newspapers, magazines, and lengthy articles. Reading was not merely an academic exercise; it was entertainment. Students consumed hundreds of pages of novels throughout the year and built the mental muscles necessary for concentration and comprehension.

Today, many young people consume information almost exclusively through short-form videos, social media clips, memes, and AI-generated summaries.

Why struggle through a chapter when a 60-second video promises the same information?

The problem is that it doesn't.

Reading is not simply a method of acquiring facts. Reading develops attention span. It strengthens memory. It builds vocabulary. It teaches reasoning. It trains the brain to follow complex arguments and connect ideas over extended periods of time.

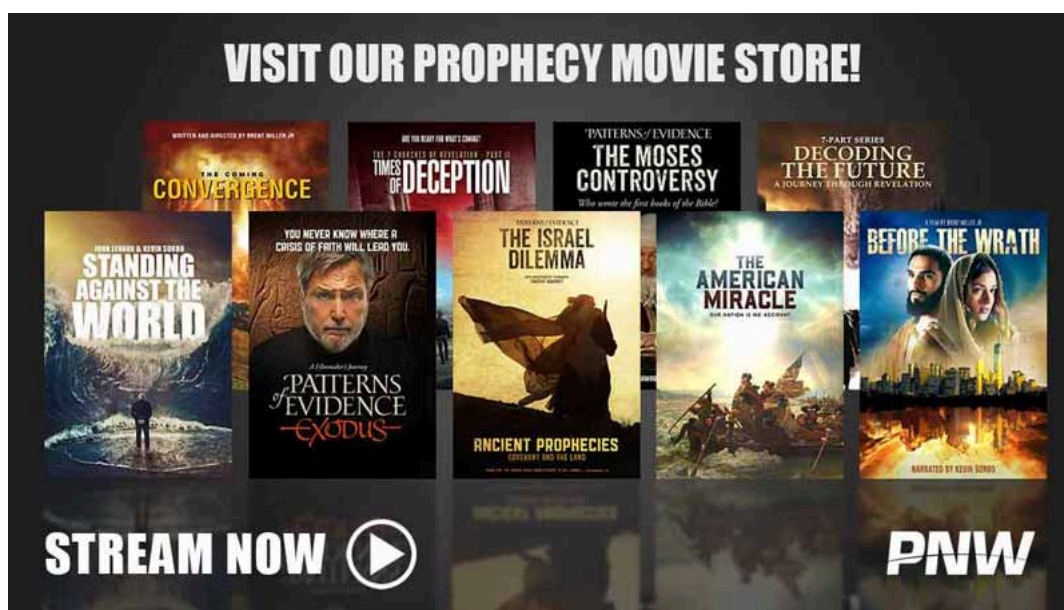
Video content excels at delivering information quickly. Reading excels at teaching people how to think.

Those are not the same thing.

The consequences are already beginning to appear.

At the educational level, colleges are increasingly forced to lower expectations or provide remedial support for students who arrive unprepared for traditional academic work.

At the workforce level, employers increasingly complain that younger workers struggle with written communication, technical manuals, reports, contracts, and detailed instructions.



(<https://prophecynewswatch.com/shop.cfm>)

At the societal level, the implications become even more troubling.

A population that cannot carefully read and analyze information becomes more vulnerable to manipulation. Complex issues are reduced to slogans. Nuance disappears. Emotional reactions replace thoughtful analysis.

When people lose the ability to engage with lengthy arguments, public discourse naturally becomes shallower.

This may help explain why modern debates often generate more outrage than understanding.

There is also an economic dimension.

Many of the highest-paying careers still depend heavily upon advanced reading comprehension. Lawyers analyze documents. Engineers study technical specifications. Medical professionals absorb vast quantities of research. Business leaders evaluate contracts, reports, and market analysis.

Strong readers gain access to opportunities that weaker readers often cannot.

In many ways, reading remains one of the greatest economic advantages a person can develop.

Yet perhaps the most overlooked consequence is the spiritual one.

For Christians, this crisis strikes at the heart of discipleship itself.

God chose to reveal Himself primarily through a written book.

The Bible contains history, poetry, prophecy, wisdom literature, letters, parables, apocalyptic visions, and theological instruction. Understanding Scripture requires careful reading, reflection, comparison, interpretation, and meditation.

A five-minute devotional video cannot replace that.

Neither can listening to a sermon once a week.

Pastors can teach. Podcasts can encourage. Christian influencers can inspire.

But none of them can substitute for personally opening God's Word and studying it for yourself.

The Bereans in Acts were praised because they searched the Scriptures daily to verify what they were being taught. They were not passive consumers of religious content. They were active students of God's Word.

That requires reading.

It requires concentration.

It requires the ability to follow arguments across chapters, understand context, compare passages, and think deeply about truth.

If the next generation loses those skills, they become increasingly dependent on others to tell them what the Bible says rather than discovering it themselves.

That is a dangerous place for any believer to be.

Perhaps this is why Bible literacy continues to decline even among churchgoers. Many Christians consume endless amounts of content about Scripture while spending very little time actually reading Scripture.

The solution is neither complicated nor easy.

We must read again.

Parents need to prioritize books over screens. Schools need to restore reading fundamentals. Churches need to encourage Bible engagement beyond Sunday mornings.

Most importantly, individuals must reclaim the discipline of sustained reading.

The ability to sit quietly with a book, wrestle with ideas, and follow a thought from beginning to end may seem old-fashioned in an age of endless scrolling.

But it remains one of the most powerful skills a person can possess.

A society that stops reading eventually loses the ability to think deeply.

And a church that stops reading God's Word risks forgetting the very truths that gave it life in the first place.

Liked this article? Don't miss an urgent PNW update.

Subscribe to PNW

[Back to home page \(https://www.prophecynewswatch.com\)](https://www.prophecynewswatch.com)

PNW SHOP



Standing Against the World (https://prophecynewswatch.com/product.cfm?product_id=88)

1

(https://prophecynewswatch.com/product.cfm?product_id=88)

The Israel Dilemma (https://prophecynewswatch.com/product.cfm?product_id=78)

2



(https://prophecynewswatch.com/product.cfm?product_id=78)



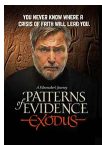
The American Miracle (https://prophecynewswatch.com/product.cfm?product_id=77) 3

(https://prophecynewswatch.com/product.cfm?product_id=77)



Before the Wrath (https://prophecynewswatch.com/product.cfm?product_id=67) 4

(https://prophecynewswatch.com/product.cfm?product_id=67)



Patterns of Evidence: Exodus (https://prophecynewswatch.com/product.cfm?product_id=87) 5

(https://prophecynewswatch.com/product.cfm?product_id=87)

OTHER NEWS

JUNE 29, 2026 **Iran Was The Warning. China Could Be The Catastrophe. (article.cfm?recent_news_id=10167)**

If Iran can shake the global economy by threatening the flow of oil, China possesses something arguably even more powerful--the ability to...

 [Read Full Story](#) (article.cfm?recent_news_id=10167)

JUNE 29, 2026 **The King's New Role Is A Mirror Of Britain's Soul (article.cfm?recent_news_id=10166)**

For centuries, the British monarch has stood as one of the world's most recognizable public symbols of Christianity. Kings and queens were...

 [Read Full Story](#) (article.cfm?recent_news_id=10166)

JUNE 29, 2026 **When the Culture's View Of Family Invades the Church (article.cfm?recent_news_id=10165)**

It has been stated many times that the downfall of every great civilization, as well as institution, comes from within--not from aggressiv...

 [Read Full Story](#) (article.cfm?recent_news_id=10165)

JUNE 29, 2026 **Methodists Punish Seminary For Believing The Bible (article.cfm?recent_news_id=10164)**

Imagine telling the apostles that one day a Christian seminary would be punished--not for denying Scripture, but for believing it. Sadly, ...

 [Read Full Story](#) (article.cfm?recent_news_id=10164)

JUNE 26, 2026 **Should Christians Teach Their Children Bible Prophecy? (article.cfm?recent_news_id=10156)**

For many believers, the answer is not as obvious as it should be. Some Christians assume prophecy is too complicated for children. Others ...

 [Read Full Story](#) (article.cfm?recent_news_id=10156)

JUNE 26, 2026 **Failure To Launch Generation? One-Third Still Live With Their Parents (article.cfm?recent_news_id=10155)**

Americans that are over the age of 55 control approximately 73 percent of all wealth in the United States. Americans that are age 55 or yo...

 [Read Full Story](#) (article.cfm?recent_news_id=10155)

JUNE 26, 2026 **James Talarico: 'A Christian Who Hates Christianity' (article.cfm?recent_news_id=10154)**

Texas Rep. James Talarico (D) is coming under fire for a previous podcast in which he told the host, "I always think of myself as a Christ...

 [Read Full Story](#) (article.cfm?recent_news_id=10154)

GET BREAKING NEWS

Enter Your Email

Subscribe to PNW



© 2026 Prophecy News Watch. All Rights Reserved.

Located in Coeur D Alene, Idaho - USA.

Call Toll Free: 1-877-561-4442

Email: Info@ProphecyNewsWatch.com

Visit us on social media.



(<https://www.facebook.com/ProphecyNewsWatch>)